



FSFlyingSchool for X-Plane[®] Voice Command Pack PRO

Manual

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Note - The FSFlyingSchool 2024 for X-Plane Voice Command Pack PRO requires Windows Speech Recognition functioning at an accurate rate. **Windows Speech Recognition must be producing accurate results in order to enjoy this product.**

FSFlyingSchool's software is not to be considered,
in any way, implied, certified, suitable or valid for the
training of any person for the operation
of any aircraft or vehicle of any kind.

Introduction

Welcome to the **FSFlyingSchool 2024 for X-Plane Voice Command Pack PRO!**

To get the most out of this product, please read this manual.

FSFlyingSchool uses sophisticated logic to analyze your flying technique, to help you refine and demonstrate your flying skills. Several of FSFlyingSchool's methods will be new, even to veteran simulation pilots, so please read about them in this manual, to discover how FSFlyingSchool works, what it is telling you, and why.

The FSFlyingSchool 2024 for X-Plane Voice Command Pack PRO adds a whole new level of realism, atmosphere and fun to your flights with FSFlyingSchool 2024 for X-Plane.

Installation

There is longer a separate license for this Pack – it is included with FSFlyingSchool.

You can fly with the special Voice Command Pack PRO treatment of your flight *anywhere you fly*.

Windows Speech Recognition

In order to use the **Voice Command Pack PRO** it is **essential to understand** that the speech technology itself is driven by **Windows** and can be set up and tested completely independent of FSFlyingSchool. Indeed - this is precisely the way Windows Speech Recognition needs to be installed, configured and tested - all before the **Voice Command Pack PRO** can be expected to function.

FSFS-Tip If your PC is **Vista, Windows 7** or above you already have Windows Speech Recognition installed - you do not need to download and install it.
However – you do need to *configure* it and *train* it (see below).

Installing Microsoft Speech Recognition

(Skip this section if your PC is Vista or Windows 7 or above)

If you are using Windows XP and already have Windows Speech **Recognition** installed on your PC you will not need to install it again. You must check for this by going to the Windows Control Panel and looking for the **Speech** icon.

If it is there - open it and check to see if you have a section marked *Speech Recognition*. If it is not there - you need to install it.

If it is already there - make sure that the version is *Microsoft English Recognizer v5.1 (or above)*

If it is not version 5.1 or above you need to install it.

If you need to install it, we have created a special installation program to help you.

You can get it from here. (It is free).

<http://www.fsinventions.com/MicrosoftSpeechForFSFlyingSchoolSetup.exe>

Microphone Configuration

Once you are certain you have Windows speech recognition on your PC you must configure your microphone for optimum speech recognition.

In the Windows Control Panel, open the **Speech** icon. In the Microphone section you can adjust its configuration and most importantly change its **input volume** to a suitable level.

Speech Recognition Profiles

With speech recognition installed and your microphone configured for it, you are ready to create a speech recognition profile. If you already have one you are happy with, which recognizes almost everything you say, then you have nothing more to do.

If you do not, then you need to create a *new* speech recognition profile.

You can do this at the Recognition Profiles section located by opening the Windows Control Panel **Speech** icon.

The key thing you will do, either by using its 'new user wizard' (which guides you through the process), or by hand, is **train** the profile to understand *your voice*.

You can spend as long as you like with this, but we recommend that you do at least 10 minutes speech recognition training to get the most out of Windows Speech Recognition.

Make certain that Windows Speech Recognition training recognizes almost everything you say *before* trying the FSFlyingSchool 2024 for X-Plane 11 and X-Plane 10 Voice Command Pack PRO.

Potential issues with Speech Recognition

- Background noise

It is obvious that the quieter your background is, the better chance your PC has to understand what is being said to it.

- Microphone position

Be sure to position your microphone with the help of the Windows speech software. It should not be picking up excessive noise from your breathing or 'pop' and 'hiss' from your speech. A little off to the side of your mouth is the usual position.

- Microphone volume

This must be set correctly using the Windows speech software. It may need to be considerably different to where it was set before you used Windows Speech Recognition.

- Microphone quality

The better the microphone the better the results. However, we get very satisfactory results with very *inexpensive* microphone/headsets.

- Insufficient training for the Speech Recognition Profile

This is a hugely important area. If you have a broad accent or 'unique' speech, you may need to spend rather more time on this. Every little helps.

- Feedback from PC speakers

If your PC speakers are on, these are creating background noise. If speech recognition is suffering, turn them down or turn them off.

- Feedback from headset speakers

If on, these may be creating background noise. If speech recognition is suffering, turn them down and make sure that they are covering your ears so that the least amount of sound escapes from them into the microphone.

- Command recognition failure and false command recognition

Triggered by imprecise speech or background noise. Remember that the volume of ATC, lessons, engines, environment, etc all create background noise. Try fine-tuning the volume levels so that they do not interfere with speech recognition.

You may also wish to select the mode at the Settings Screen of FSFlyingSchool which allows you to control speech input with the *FSFS Mic Key* (a special key which turns the microphone on and off) in order to reduce unwanted speech input.

Using Speech Recognition in FSFlyingSchool 2024 for X-Plane

There are 3 modes within FSFS which can be used to control speech recognition.

These are controlled at the FSFS *Settings* screen, *Voice Commands* section, *Status* drop-down list control.

- Off No voice commands
- Key Controlled by FSFS Mic Key [**Ctrl Shift 5**]
- On Listen at all times

If the second option is chosen, the user will control speech with the *FSFS Mic Key* - the **Ctrl Shift 5** key on the main keyboard (*not* on the numeric keypad).

When the key is pressed, the Mic is toggled ON.
When pressed again, the Mic is toggled OFF.

The change in status is shown briefly on the screen in X-Plane when the key is pressed.

FSFS Mic:ON FSFlyingSchool 2024 for X-Plane will listen to your commands.

FSFS Mic:OFF FSFlyingSchool 2024 for X-Plane will not listen to your commands.

When a command is *recognized*, the screen in X-Plane briefly displays the confirmation: **Roger**

If commands are being recognized when the pilot is not speaking commands, this is because the microphone is picking up background noise.

FSFlyingSchool 2024 for X-Plane has a feature to take you directly to Windows Speech Settings.

Just press the

View Windows Speech Settings

button at the Settings screen of FSFlyingSchool 2024 for X-Plane.

Note – *this button* may not function on PCs running a *non-English version of Windows XP*, in which case you should just access the Windows Speech Settings via the Windows Control Panel.

IMPORTANT! Note that although your PC must be capable of speech recognition and it must be trained to recognize *your* voice, you must also make certain that at the time you *launch* FSFlyingSchool your PC is not listening to you.

Any application that listens to your voice must be closed (shut down) *before* launching FSFlyingSchool if you want to use FSFlyingSchool's Voice Commands.

IMPORTANT! Most PCs have multiple sound cards within them. You must choose from the sound cards listed at the '*Sound Card Setup - Other*' section of the Settings Screen of FSFlyingSchool to make sure that the correct card is chosen for use with FSFlyingSchool's voice commands. It is very likely that *only one* of the cards listed there will be suitable. If that card is not selected, voice commands will not be heard.

Quick Start

Please read this manual if you want to get the most out of flying with the FSFlyingSchool 2024 for X-Plane Voice Command Pack PRO.

If you would prefer to do this later and want to jump right into the cockpit, here's what you should do next:

- Launch X-Plane.
- Create or select a flight in X-Plane.
- Get that plane ready to fly, either in mid-air or on the ground. Get yourself at the controls of the plane.
- Launch the FSFlyingSchool program.
- Press the *Connect Button* in FSFlyingSchool.
- Switch back to X-Plane and enjoy your flight with FSFlyingSchool by your side!
- **But – you really should read this too...**

There are several new features you will want to understand, including a special new key. Read more about these features in detail in this manual.

Voice Commands

With the addition of the FSFlyingSchool 2024 for X-Plane Voice Command Pack PRO, your instructors will be *listening* as well as talking!

The Voice Command Pack PRO will make your whole experience more realistic and fun by giving you an entire set of voice commands designed to get lots of valuable new information from your instructor, and control your interaction with FSFlyingSchool without using the keyboard.

FSFS-Tip When a command is detected, the screen in X-Plane briefly displays the confirmation: **Roger**
If commands are being detected when the pilot is not speaking commands, this is because the microphone is picking up background noise, very likely from PC or headset speakers..

The following is a list of Voice Commands your team of instructors will now understand.

Flight Mode Control

- **[Next flight mode]**
Advances to next FSFlyingSchool flight mode (Ctrl Shift Z).
- **[Previous flight mode]**
Backs up to previous FSFlyingSchool flight mode (Ctrl Shift X).
- **[Ready for take off]**
Advances from taxi to take off mode.
- **[We are cruising]**
Moves from take off or from landing to cruise mode.
- **[Prepare for landing]**
Advances from cruise to landing mode.
- **[Taxiing Out]**
Moves from take off to taxi mode.
- **[Executing go around]**
Moves from landing to cruise mode.

Flight Plan Information *(Requires a Flight Plan to be loaded into FSBFlyingSchool)*

- **[Next waypoint]**
Reports distance in NM to the next waypoint in the flight plan. Helps you make sure you are ready for the waypoint so you can cross it accurately.
- **[Destination runway]**
Reports details of the flight plan destination runway. Runway ID, elevation, length, surface type. This is useful in preparing your landing and making sure the runway is suited to your aircraft's requirements.
- **[Flight plan remaining]**
Reports remaining distance in NM based on flight plan. Note that if you miss a waypoint in the flight plan, the distance reported will still include that waypoint. Make sure you pass waypoints correctly.
- **[Runway heading]**
Reports exact heading of the flight plan destination runway. This needs to be set on the NAV1 OBS or your autopilot's *course* setting before your approach.
- **[Flight time remaining]**
Reports remaining flight time based on flight plan and *current* ground speed. As this is based on the current ground speed, this is of course a general estimate of the remaining flight time and will be affected by changes in wind direction and speed, climbs and descents, speed regulations, etc.
- **[Destination airport data]**
Opens a browser containing detailed real-world information about your destination airport with links to lots of useful resources from the splendid *SkyVector* website for all airports and also the excellent *AirNav* website for U.S. airports.
Note – If you look at this browser, your simulator will still be running so don't forget to fly your aircraft!
- **[Descent rate to destination]**
Reports flight plan destination airport ICAO code (e.g. Kilo Lima Alpha X-Ray) and the descent rate in feet per minute in order to arrive at the runway elevation based on the current ground speed. The pilot should not necessarily begin a descent at that rate as he/she may be many hours away from the destination.
If by contrast the airport is drawing near, this command gives the pilot a good idea of what to do. This can be very instructive as when flying around for fun in your flight simulator it is very easy to make the mistake of heading off toward an airport with a landing in mind only to realize, when you get there, that you are *far too high* to begin an approach.
- **[Waypoint bearing]**
Reports the course needed to fly to the next waypoint in the flight plan. This handy feature means that you can then set the autopilot heading bug to that course as a reminder or indeed to direct the autopilot if heading hold is also engaged.
You can also set the course using the NAV1 and NAV2 OBS knobs and fly to the waypoint using VOR navigation if it is a VOR. Great practice!
- **[Waypoint time]**
Reports the time it will take to reach the next flight plan waypoint based on the current ground speed and distance to the waypoint. As this is based on the current ground speed, this is of course a general estimate of the time and will be affected by changes in wind direction and speed, climbs and descents, speed regulations, etc.

- **[Waypoint frequency]**

Reports radio frequency of next waypoint if it is a VOR. *(We also hope to add this for NDBs.)*

Note that the X-Plane flight plan may say that a NAVAID is a VOR when it is actually a DME with no VOR (not a VOR/DME). If this is the case, the instructor will reply "Negative" as it is not actually a VOR. If the NAVAID is an NDB, the instructor will reply "Negative - NDB".

This is a handy feature for practicing VOR navigation.

- **[Divert to Alternate]**

Simply say this command and your instructor will know that you have changed the FSFlyingSchool flight plan to fly to **the last airport you requested information on**. This works with any airport the instructor has described to you as a result of any of these commands:

"Nearest Airport?"

"Airport [x] o'clock?"

"Specify Airport"

The instructor will respond with its ICAO code, bearing, distance, runway length. If you have not asked for information on an airport already you will get the response "Negative."

- **[Next Runway]**

Simply say this command and your instructor will know that you have changed the FSFlyingSchool flight plan to land at the next (numerically listed) runway at the airport in the flight plan. You can say this several times if you wish in order to find the runway you want. The instructor will respond with details on the newly chosen destination runway. If there is no flight plan in FSFlyingSchool you will get the response "Negative."

Very useful for changing to a better suited runway, especially if just directed to it by ATC.

General Information

- **[Gear extension speed]**
Reports maximum gear extension speed. You must not lower your gear when above this speed or it may be damaged.
- **[NAV1 information]**
Reports on the NAVAID to which NAV1 radio is currently tuned, including NAVAID ID, DME, ILS/LOC, runway.
- **[Next flap speed]**
Reports the next speed at which you can lower MORE flaps. If you are already at full flaps, this will repeat the full flaps speed. This can help keep you from lowering flaps when too fast and is very useful when flying an aircraft with a large number of flap settings.
- **[Ground Speed]**
Reports ground speed. It is worth noting that this will often be very different to your IAS.
- **[Above ground level]**
Reports above ground level (altitude above ground rather than above MSL).
- **[Visibility and wind]**
Reports current visibility, wind direction and strength.
- **[Display data]**
Displays FSFlyingSchool data in X-Plane. (Ctrl Shift D)
Displays the following: NAV1 OBS setting; Current Waypoint number and ID; Current Flight Mode; Type of Aircraft Data in use by FSFlyingSchool (FSR or FSU); Current Circuit Leg (if you are flying circuits)
- **[Airport ???? o'clock?]** (*Recognizes "one" through to "twelve" o'clock*)
To be clear - the pilot will say "Airport one o'clock?" or "Airport twelve o'clock?" etc.
Reports the nearest airport at that bearing. It is essential to say "uh clock" rather than "oh clock".
The instructor will identify the airport, its distance, runway elevation, length, surface type.
If the instructor detects no airport at that bearing, he/she will say "negative".
This is an excellent, easy way to become familiar with your surroundings!
- **[Where's the airport?]**
The pilot must say "**Where's** the airport?" and not "Where **is** the airport?".
The instructor identifies the flight plan destination airport and its bearing in the "clock" format, e.g. "2 o'clock", and the distance.
This is very handy when, for example, you are trying to find a grass strip with no lights even during the day, and equally when looking for a larger busy airport which is far away or just hard to see.
- **[Nearest airport]**
Reports nearest airport with its ICAO code (e.g. Kilo Lima Alpha X-Ray), bearing, distance, runway length. This works for airports within approximately 35 nautical miles of the airplane.
If you are just flying around for fun and want somewhere "to go" or if you need to get down onto the ground in a hurry, this feature is a winner!
- **[Cruise altitude]**
This requests that your instructor monitors your altitude while cruising and if you fly more than 100 feet above or below this altitude, he/she will let you know until you resume the altitude you chose to monitor.
Flying at a constant altitude *without the autopilot* can be a real challenge, especially in rough weather. Can you master this essential skill?
The first time the pilot says this, the instructor will acknowledge by saying "Maintain altitude" and will expect that *the current* altitude be maintained.
As you would expect, this command will only be acknowledged when the pilot is in

FSFlyingSchool's *cruise mode* section of the flight.

Cruise altitude monitoring can be cancelled either by leaving FSFlyingSchool's *cruise mode* (for example advancing to landing mode) or by giving the command again, which ends monitoring cruise altitude. In summary, the command toggles cruise altitude monitoring on and off. When the command is used to toggle off, the instructor will acknowledge by saying "Affirmative".

- **[Cruise airspeed]**

This requests that your instructor monitors your airspeed while cruising and if you fly more than 10 KIAS above or below this airspeed, he/she will let you know until you resume the airspeed you chose to monitor.

Flying at a constant airspeed *without the autopilot and/or autothrottle* can be a real challenge, especially in rough weather. Can you master this essential skill?

The first time the pilot says this, the instructor will acknowledge by saying "Maintain indicated airspeed" and will expect that *the current* airspeed be maintained.

As you would expect, this command will only be acknowledged when the pilot is in FSFlyingSchool's *cruise mode* section of the flight.

Cruise airspeed monitoring can be cancelled either by leaving FSFlyingSchool's *cruise mode* (for example advancing to landing mode) or by giving the command again, which ends monitoring cruise airspeed. In summary, the command toggles cruise airspeed monitoring on and off. When the command is used to toggle off, the instructor will acknowledge by saying "Affirmative".

- **[Fuel consumed]**

Reports fuel consumed since this flight in FSFlyingSchool started. A flight starts when you press the 'connect' button in FSFlyingSchool or when you complete a flight and start a new one. The instructor will report the fuel consumed in gallons in smaller aircraft and in pounds in a heavy. Fuel planning is essential and this feature will help you develop a realistic fuel conscious mindset.

- **[Gross weight]**

Reports gross weight in pounds. Know your limits!

- **[Specify Airport]**

Say this command to let your instructor know that you are about to request information on an airport. Your instructor will confirm he/she is waiting with the response "Airport..."

Say the 4 letter airport ICAO code using the phonetic alphabet (e.g. Kilo Lima Alpha X-Ray). If you have announced the code of a valid airport, your instructor will confirm this by replying with its ICAO code, bearing, distance, runway length. This works for airports anywhere in the world. ICAO codes must contain only letters. An incorrect ICAO code gets the response "Negative."

Very useful when used with the "Divert to Alternate" command when you want to fly to a specific airport and don't want to return to the FSFlyingSchool flight plan screen. And also for just getting general information! Now you can TELL your instructor where you want to go!

Other Commands

- **[Be quiet please]**
Interrupts the instructor with your request to stop talking. This can be very useful if the instructor is telling you something that you are already familiar with and don't need help with.
Note that in the case of very long phrases from your instructors, you may nevertheless have to wait a few moments for them to finish.
Remember – be sure to say “...please...”
- **[Can you hear me]**
Your instructor will reply to confirm that you can be heard. If you cannot, you will need to check your configuration. Remember also that you may have turned off the *FSFS Mic Key* **[5]**
- **[Let me fly by myself]**
Instructor will monitor flight but will say nothing. All your voice commands will be processed, but your instructor will keep quiet. This is an excellent idea if you want to see how well you can fly without any verbal help.
- **[I want your help]**
Tells instructor that you want to hear his/her help. The instructor will reply to confirm that your command was understood.
- **[Next checklist] (Requires an FSFlyingSchool aircraft Detail Pack)**
Instructor will read the next checklist from your Detail Pack. (Ctrl Shift N)
- **[Which checklist] (Requires an FSFlyingSchool aircraft Detail Pack)**
Displays the type of Detail Pack checklist that would be read next in X-Plane. (Ctrl Shift B)
- **[Circuit mode]**
Toggles FSFlyingSchool's Circuit Mode on or off. (Ctrl Shift Space)
- **[Airmanship test]**
Toggles one of FSFlyingSchool's Airmanship Tests on or off. (Ctrl Shift C)
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Flight Mode Control	
Executing go around	Moves from landing to cruise mode.
Next flight mode	Advances to next FSFlyingSchool flight mode. (Ctrl Shift Z)
Prepare for landing	Advances from cruise to landing mode.
Previous flight mode	Backs up to previous FSFlyingSchool flight mode. (Ctrl Shift X)
Ready for take off	Advances from taxi to take off mode
Taxiing Out	Moves from take off to taxi mode.
We are cruising	Moves from take off or from landing to cruise mode.
Flight Plan	
Descent rate to destination	Reports descent rate in FPM to arrive at runway based on ground speed.
Destination airport data	Opens web browser and shows data for destination airport.
Destination runway	Reports details of flight plan destination runway.
Divert to Alternate	Change destination airport in FSFlyingSchool flight plan.
Flight plan remaining	Reports remaining distance in NM based on flight plan.
Flight time remaining	Reports remaining flight time based on flight plan and <i>current</i> ground speed.
Next Runway	Change FSFlyingSchool flight plan to land at next numerically listed runway.
Next waypoint	Reports distance in NM to next waypoint in flight plan.
Runway heading	Reports exact heading of flight plan destination runway.
Waypoint bearing	Reports course needed to fly to next waypoint in flight plan.
Waypoint frequency	Reports radio frequency of next waypoint if it is a VOR.
Waypoint time	Reports time to reach next flight plan waypoint based on current ground speed.
General Information	
Above ground level	Reports above ground level.
Airport ???? o'clock?	Reports the nearest airport at that bearing.
Cruise airspeed	Requests instructor to monitor your airspeed while cruising.
Cruise altitude	Requests instructor to monitor your altitude while cruising.
Display data	Displays FSFlyingSchool data in X-Plane. (Ctrl Shift D)
Fuel consumed	Reports fuel consumed since this flight in FSFlyingSchool started.
Gear extension speed	Reports maximum gear extension speed.
Gross weight	Reports gross weight in pounds.
Ground Speed	Reports ground speed.
NAV1 information	Reports NAVAID NAV1 is receiving, including NAVAID ID, DME, ILS/LOC, runway.
Nearest airport	Reports nearest airport with ICAO code, bearing, distance, runway length.
Next flap speed	Reports next speed at which you can lower MORE flaps.
Specify Airport	Announce that you are about to request information on an airport.
Visibility and wind	Reports current visibility, wind direction and strength.
Where's the airport?	Reports flight plan destination airport and its bearing in "clock" format.

Other Functions	
Airmanship test	Toggles one of FSBFlyingSchool's Airmanship Tests on or off. (Ctrl Shift C)
Be quiet please	Interrupts instructor with your request to stop talking.
Can you hear me	Your instructor will reply to confirm that you can be heard.
Circuit mode	Toggles FSBFlyingSchool's Circuit Mode on or off.(Ctrl Shift Space)
I want your help	Tells instructor that you want to hear his/her help.
Let me fly by myself	Instructor will monitor flight but will say nothing.
Next checklist	Instructor will read next checklist. (Ctrl Shift N)
Which checklist	Displays type of checklist that would be read next in simulator. (Ctrl Shift B)

Alphabetical Voice Command List

Above ground level	Let me fly by myself
Airmanship test	NAV1 information
Airport ????? o'clock?	Nearest airport
Be quiet please	Next checklist
Can you hear me	Next flap speed
Circuit mode	Next flight mode
Cruise airspeed	Next Runway
Cruise altitude	Next waypoint
Descent rate to destination	Prepare for landing
Destination airport data	Previous flight mode
Destination runway	Ready for take off
Display data	Runway heading
Divert to Alternate	Specify Airport
Executing go around	Taxiing Out
Flight plan remaining	Visibility and wind
Flight time remaining	Waypoint bearing
Fuel consumed	Waypoint frequency
Gear extension speed	Waypoint time
Gross weight	We are cruising
Ground Speed	Where's the airport?
I want your help	Which checklist

We hope you enjoy your flights with the
FSFlyingSchool 2024 for X-Plane Voice Command Pack PRO!